

PRINTABLE WALKTHROUGH CHECKLIST

OSHA Forklift / Powered Industrial Truck Walkthrough Checklist

Walk your shop with this list. Total items: 28, across 6 categories, tied to 29 CFR 1910.176 and 1910.178. This is the free walkthrough companion — for the complete 11-document Forklift/PIT Readiness Kit (written program, operator evaluation forms, inspection binders), visit giglinecompliance.com/kits/forklift-pit-readiness-kit.

Facility / site	Walked by	Date

Operator Qualification and Training

29 CFR 1910.178(l) — Operator training

- Every operator has a certificate on file naming them, the truck type, the trainer, and the date.
- Refresher training is documented every three years, or after any accident, near-miss, or unsafe operation.
- Operator evaluations were performed by a competent person, not self-signed.
- Truck-type coverage on the certificate matches the truck the operator is actually using.
- Non-certified operators are physically prevented from operating trucks (key control or lockout).

Pre-Shift Inspection

29 CFR 1910.178(q)(7) — daily examinations

- A written pre-shift inspection is completed for every truck, every shift it is used.
- Inspection checklist covers brakes, steering, controls, warning devices, mast, tires, forks, backup alarm, and horn.
- Trucks found unsafe are tagged out and removed from service until repaired.
- Completed pre-shift forms are retained (recommend 12 months) and available for OSHA on request.
- Propane, electric, and diesel trucks each have their fuel-specific checks documented.

Traveling and Load Handling

29 CFR 1910.178(n) — traveling

- Load capacity plate is legible on every truck and matches the attachment installed.
- Loads are tilted back and carried as low as possible when traveling.
- Operators sound the horn at intersections and blind corners; mirrors are installed at the worst spots.
- No riders on trucks not equipped and rated for a second operator.
- Speed limits are posted and enforced in pedestrian zones (typical 5 mph interior, walking pace near people).
- Pedestrian separation exists at the highest-risk crossings (barriers, striped walkways, or 'stop for forklifts' signage).

Charging and Refueling

29 CFR 1910.178(g) — battery, and 1910.178(f) — fuel handling

- Battery charging area is well-ventilated, no smoking, with an eye-wash station and PPE (face shield, apron, gloves) within reach.
- Propane cylinders are stored upright, secured, and away from ignition sources.
- Diesel and gasoline refueling occurs outdoors or in a designated ventilated area with the engine off.
- Spill containment is available and the response procedure is posted.

Rack, Aisle, and Storage

29 CFR 1910.176 — Materials handling, general

- Aisles are marked, unobstructed, and wide enough for the truck plus a pedestrian buffer.
- Racking is undamaged — no bent uprights, no missing footplates or beam locks.
- Damaged racking has a written removal-from-service and repair schedule.
- Overhead loads are secured or shrink-wrapped so nothing can fall on operators.

Documentation on the Wall

29 CFR 1910.178 subparts (l) and (q)

- Written PIT program is on file and available.
- Operator certificates and evaluation forms are kept for the term of employment plus three years.
- Pre-shift inspection forms are filed by truck and date.
- Maintenance / repair records are tied to the truck's serial number.

Supervisor sign-off

Complete after the walkthrough. Anything unchecked should route to a corrective-action log with an owner and a due date. Damaged racking or unqualified operators are stop-work items.

Supervisor name	
Signature	
Date completed	
Findings routed to (corrective-action log / responsible party)	

Ready for the full program? The GigLine Forklift/PIT Readiness Kit at \$150 delivers the written PIT program, operator training curriculum, pre-shift inspection forms in binder-ready format, and citation-proof records for OSHA inspections. Visit giglinecompliance.com/kits/forklift-pit-readiness-kit.

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